Channel Islands
CALIFORNIA STATE UNIVERSITY

Sneaky McGee

A Third-Person Stealth Game

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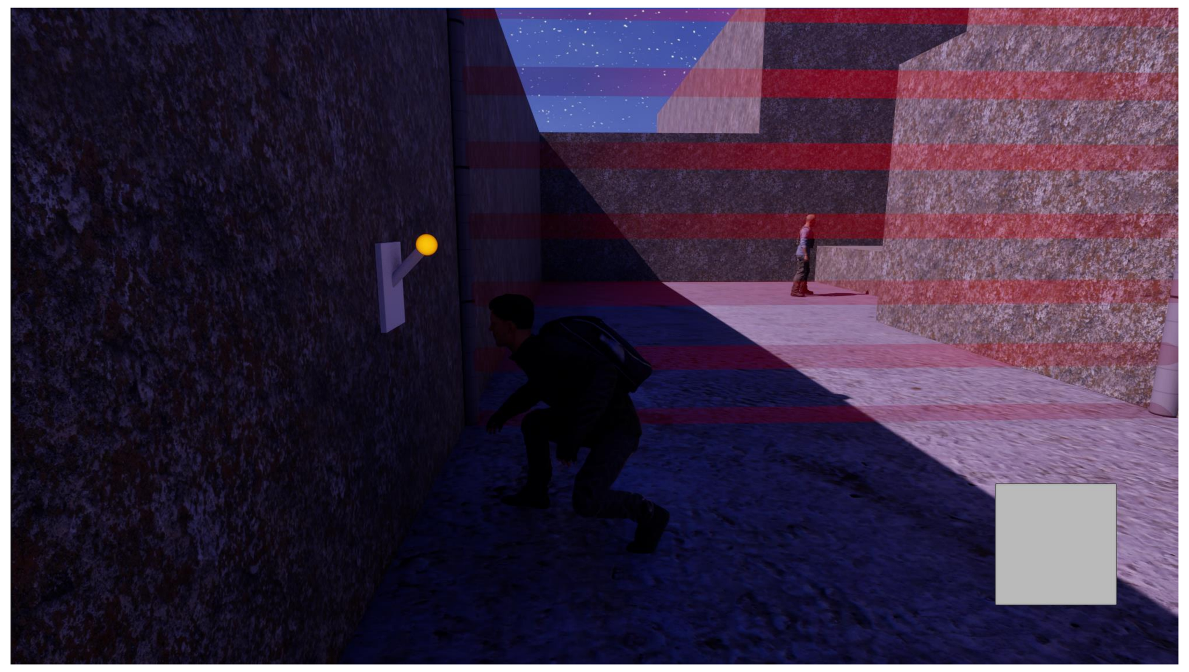
Introduction

Stealth systems walk fine lines between being engaging, frustrating, and trivial in modern times, the mechanic having the capacity to make or break the game they are utilized within.

Project Sneaky McGee seeks to engage the player with a variety of stealth mechanics to give that skulking, secret agent feel that so often is lost in modern games that chose to put the stealth in as an afterthought.



Methodology

My methodology in developing Project Sneaky McGee was scattershot, but unified under two central sets of online courses that taught me the basics of Unreal Engine 5 for both C++ and Blueprints.

After choosing Blueprints as my language of choice, and completing both courses, I switched to a less rigid development path, instead working on mechanics and sections of the level environment as I desired versus in any discernable order. This allowed me to maintain my motivation to see the project through, as well having a consistently fresh pair of eyes to develop the game with.

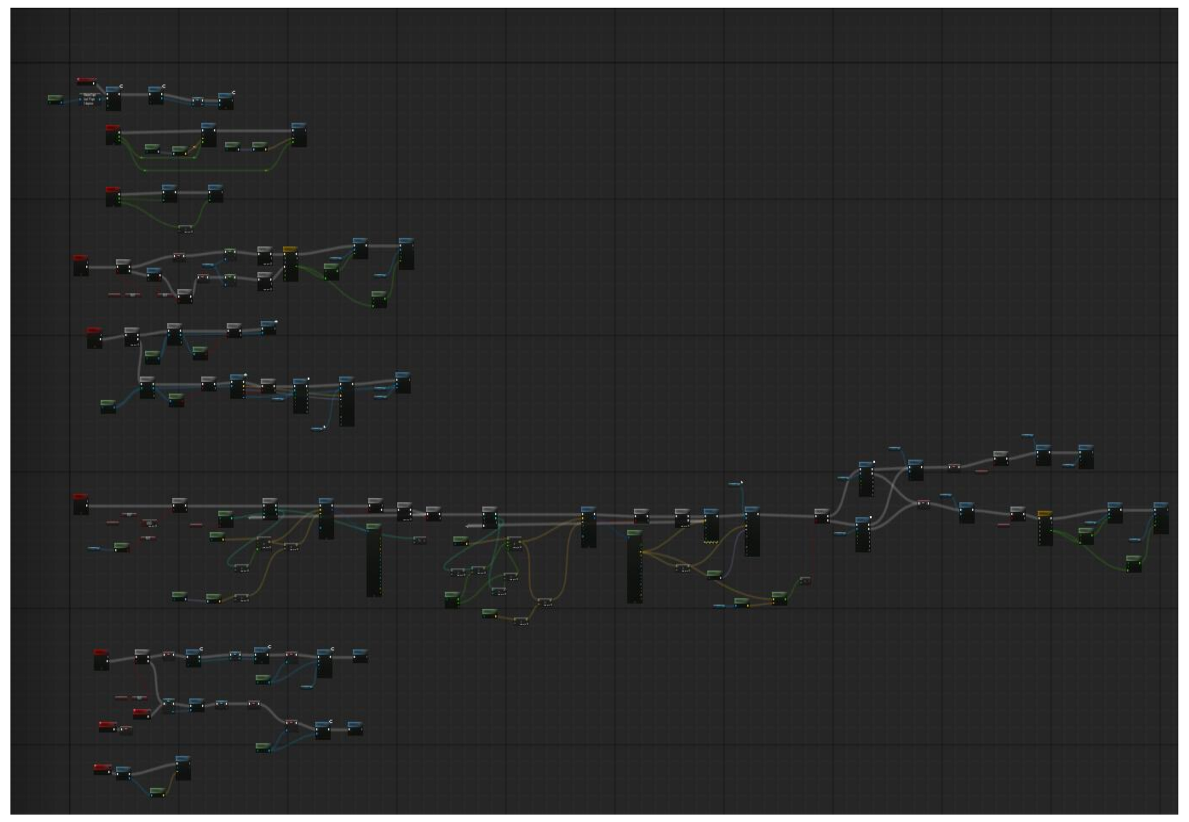
Gameplay

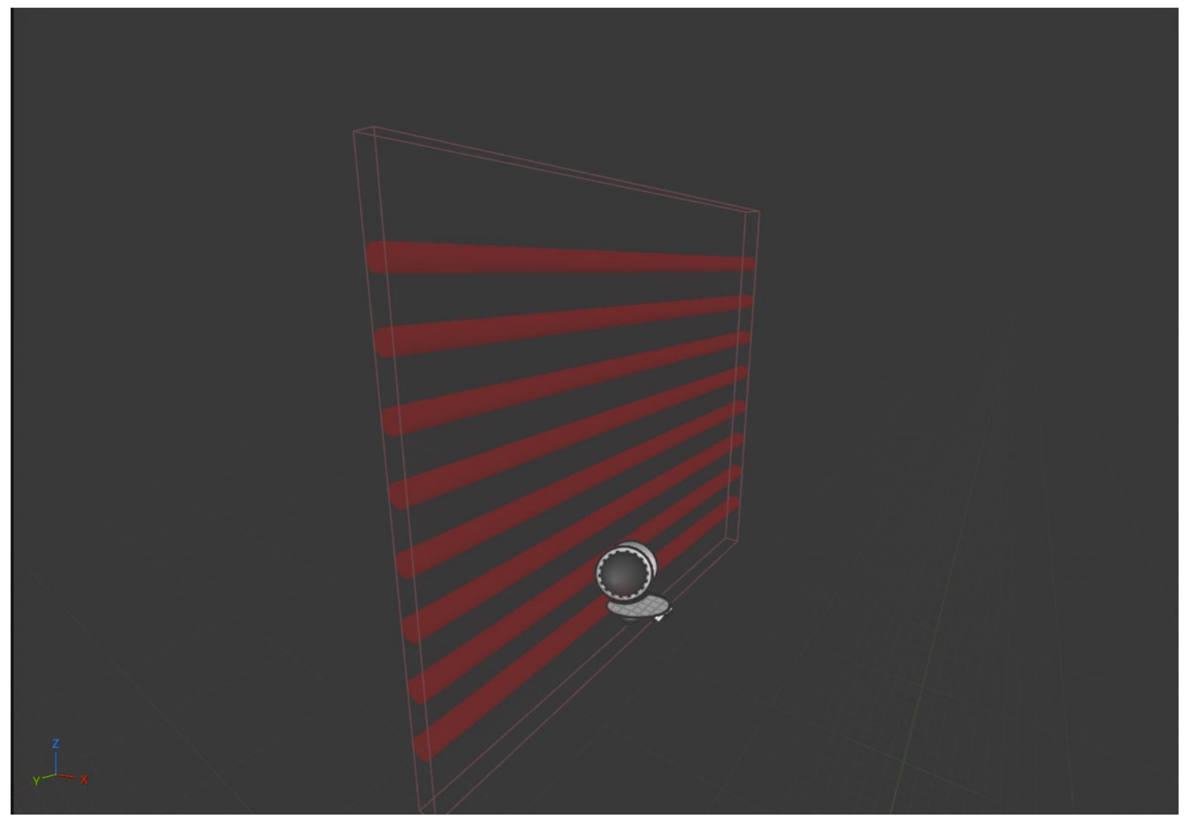
Regarding gameplay, Project Sneaky McGee leverages mainstays of the stealth game and spy genres alike, with patrolling guards, rotating security cameras, and laser gates that must be navigated through by the main player, an infiltrating spy who is searching for the Absolt Drive.

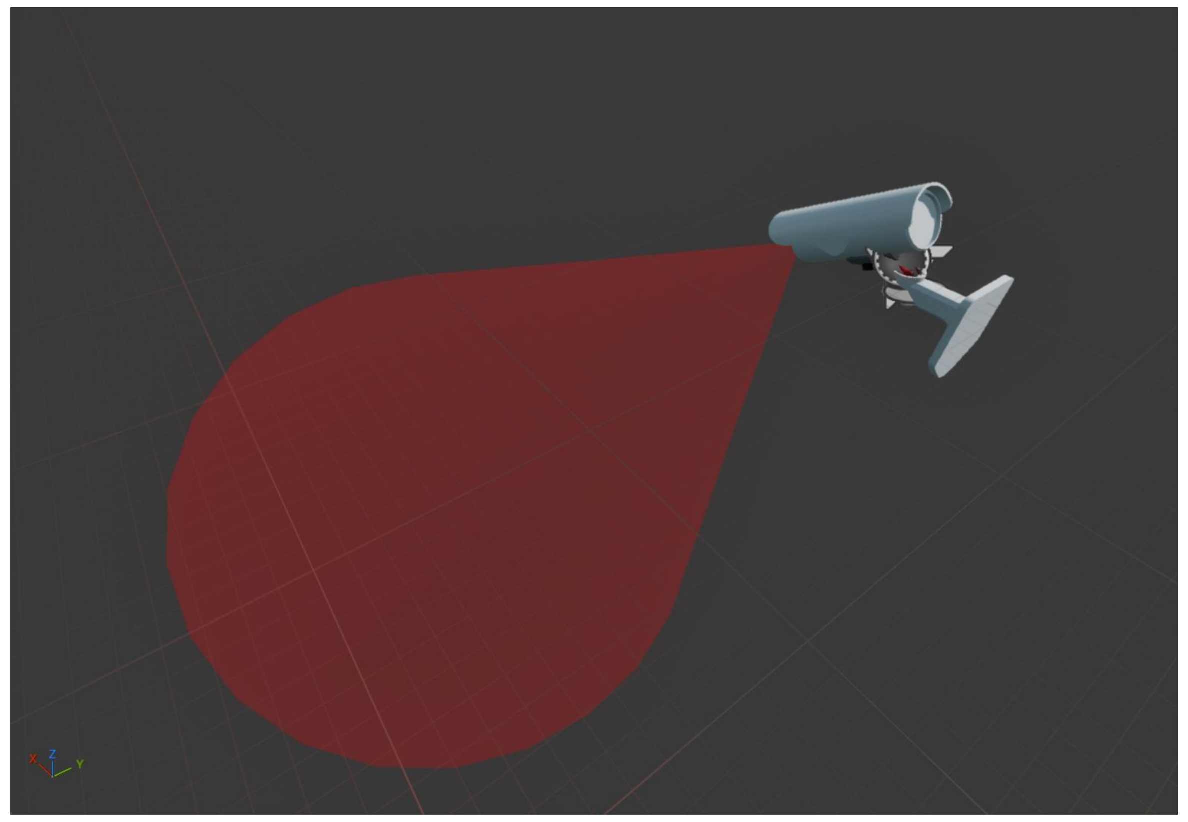
The guard is the main threat in Project Sneaky McGee, and serves as the only way for the player to functionally fail the level. In their patrol state, guards will follow a set pathing instruction until they either spot the player or the alarm is triggered via a camera or laser gate. This sets them to a pursuit mode, where they will sprint at the player in an attempt to capture them.

Laser gates and cameras are the guards' assistants, forcing the player to navigate the level in search of levers to deactivate the former, and necessitating careful position to avoid the latter. While they are not an instant loss condition if triggered, they will sound a permanent alarm that can easily strand the player without many options.

The player themself is equipped with a few tools to manage through these obstacles, with a crouch to duck behind cover and lower the chance of being spotted, and the ability to interact with switches to disarm laser gates. Additionally, the player is able to permanently dispatch guards if they approach from behind, potentially making an escape easier if the alarm is sounded.



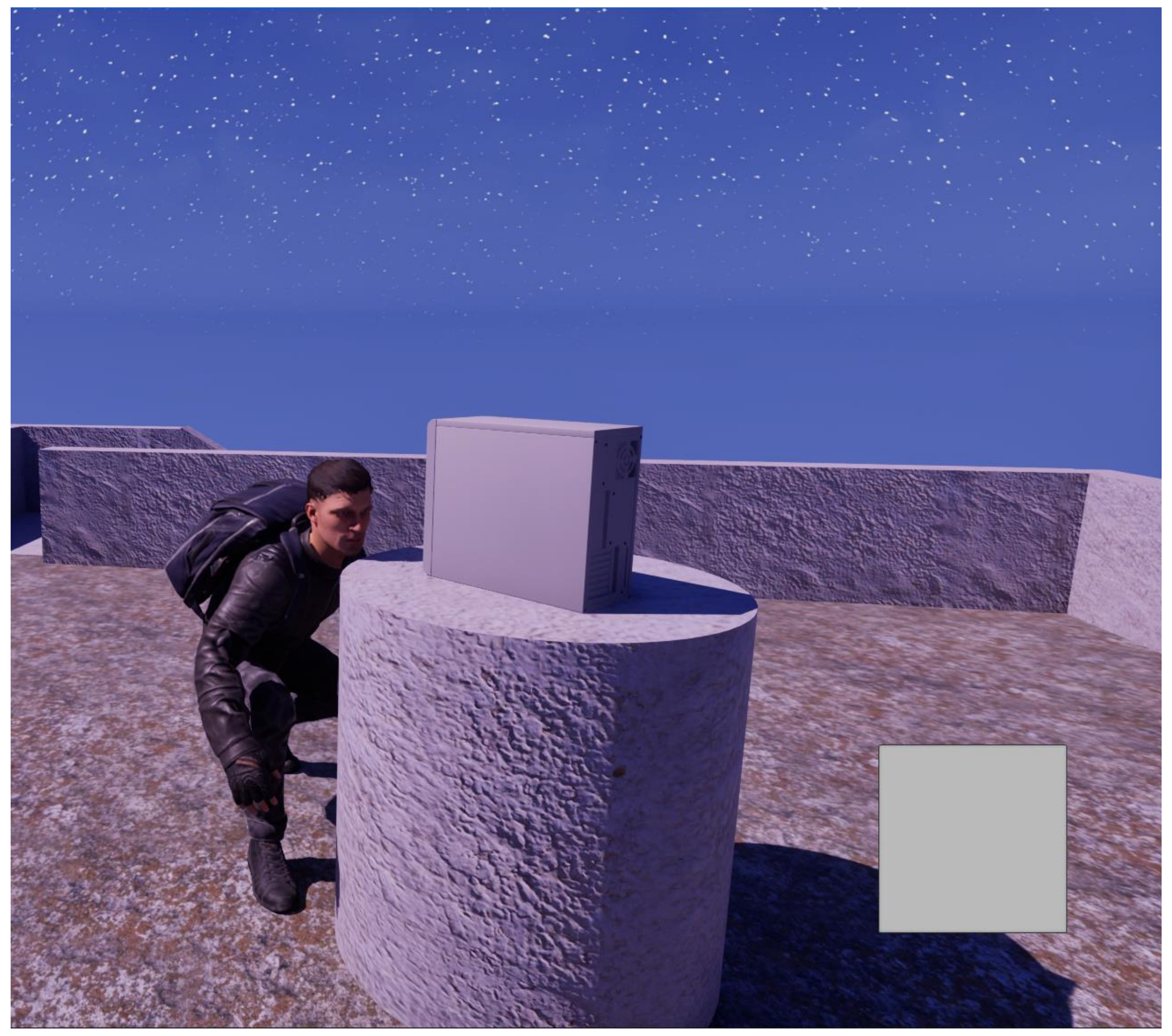




Design

Project Sneaky McGee takes place in a 3D environment, and employs a third-person perspective. This provides the player an extra layer of freedom in how they can approach a level, such as scouting corners without having to move their player model into view.

The focus of the game is on stealth, and this is reflected in its mechanics, with roaming guards, security cameras that can sound the alarm, and laser gates that have to be disarmed. Combined with a mock realistic art style, animations, and a spy-thriller sound track, the design seeks to give the player that feeling of completing an espionage mission in a movie.



Moving Forward

In the future, I would want to improve the quality of the textures and assets first and foremost, as the majority of them are simple free assets I utilized from the Unreal FAB Marketplace. Another thing I would like to implement is more levels with new mechanics as time went on, such as a lockpicking minigame, or ways to distract the guards manually.